



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

MAY 2018

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Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

The deadline for June/July is

May 18

Contributions may be brought to the office
or emailed to:
office@minnehaha.org

Minneapolis, MN 55417

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

May



SUNDAY WORSHIP

- 9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.
- 10:15 am Education and Fellowship.
- 11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in May

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
		1 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	2 10a Staff Meeting 5p Methodicals 5:30p Dinner and Program 6p Musical Rehearsal Sanctuary 6:30p Digital Kid Presentation 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	3 9a Fun & Fit 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	4 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p RCA 7p Movie Night	5 6a Joy Catering 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
6 Communion 8a Plant Sale Pickup 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 10:15a Solar Meet 11a Worship with Band 4p Youth & Conf. Classes 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	7 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy & Cub Scouts 6:30p Finance	8 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Church Council	9 5p Methodicals 5:30p Dinner and Program 6p Musical Rehearsal Sanctuary 6:45p Chancel Choir	10 Ascension 9a Fun & Fit 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6p Sanctuary Reserved	11 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p RCA 7p Fellowship Hall reserved 7p Taizé	12 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
13 Mother's Day 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 7p SAA	14 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts -	15 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters 6:30p Worship Committee	16 5p Methodicals 5:30p Dinner and Program 6p Musical Rehearsal Sanctuary 6:30p Solar Meeting 6:45p Chancel Choir	17 9a Fun & Fit 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	18 <i>Newsletter items due</i> 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p RCA	19 Armed Forces Day 8a Children's Sunday Rehearsal 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
20 Pentecost 10a Children's Sunday 2p Youth Group 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	21 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy & Cub Scouts	22 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p SPR	23 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	24 9a Fun & Fit 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	25 9a Newsletter Collation 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p RCA	26 7a MinneHarvest 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
27 10a Memorial Sunday Worship 7p SAA	28 Memorial Day 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts	29 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music	30 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	31 9a Fun & Fit 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Trustees & B+G	Notes: The calendar is accurate, to the best of our knowledge, at the time of printing. Dates and details may change at any time. Please visit www.minnehaha.org to view an up-to-date version of the calendar, and please contact Heather before scheduling any meetings or events. If they aren't on the calendar, you are not guaranteed a meeting space.	

Worship in May

If April showers bring May flowers, then I'm not quite sure what April snowstorms bring. Hopefully, May will return us to the season of spring. No matter the weather, May is a season of change. We are concluding the season of Easter on Mother's Day, and Pentecost follows the next week, with our Children's Musical happening on that day. And then Memorial Day weekend ushers us into summer. We'll still be worshipping inside for a couple more weeks as we congratulate our graduating seniors on June 3, and then the second service will move outside for the rest of the summer (please note that May 20, May 27, and June 3 are all one service Sundays with worship at 10:00 a.m.). No matter what May brings, we look forward to seeing you in worship!

6th **"Now What? Love"** John 15:9-17
Communion

13th **"Now What? Delight in God"** Psalm 1

20th **Pentecost**
Children's Musical—One Service 10:00

27th **"Send Me"** Isaiah 6:1-8
One Service 10:00

Save the Date

Future special events at Minnehaha UMC:

- June 3 – Graduation Sunday, one service at 10:00
- June 10 – Summer outdoor services begin. Blessing of bikes and bike helmets at both services, potluck picnic following the second service.
- June 18-22 – Music and Drama Camp
- June 20-22 – Vacation Bible School
- July 15 – Cowboy Sunday at 10:30 service with potluck picnic following.
- July 15 (afternoon) – July 17 (evening) – youth going into 6th and 7th grades go to Adventure Camp at Koronis
- July 29 (afternoon) – Aug 3 (afternoon) – youth going into 8th – 12th grades go to Wilderness Camp at Star Lake
- Aug. 5 – Worship at the Falls at 10:30, potluck lunch at Minnehaha Park following
- Aug. 26 – Blessing of the Animals at 10:30 service

RELIEVE EDITORIAL STRESS:

**TURN IN
YOUR ARTICLES
EARLY!**

RE M I N D E R :

**DEADLINE FOR
NEWSLETTER
ARTICLES IS**

MAY 18

Note: June and July will be in one combined issue. Make sure to plan ahead when submitting your articles!

Through May 16th

**WEDNESDAY
NIGHT
Suppers**

**Join us at Minnehaha for
Wednesday Night Suppers!**

Throughout the winter and spring, join us for supper from 5:30-6:30 in the Fellowship Hall.

Cost for Dinner:

\$5 for those 4 years and older

Free for children under 4

Family Cap: \$20

PURCHASE A PUNCH CARD & RECEIVE FOUR MEALS FREE!

Following dinner, there is programming for children from 6:15 to 7pm.

Youth Ministries

Here is a look forward at the next month of activities for Youth Ministries. We have a lot of activities coming up for our Youth and volunteers with opportunities to Seek, Serve, and to Celebrate! All the things we do best here at Minnehaha.

May 6th - Youth are giving Bibles to 2nd Graders during worship in the morning.

- Confirmation Night: Goes from 4:00-5:30pm. The younger class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Youth room and will be working on the newest edition of "Youth News". The older class will be meeting in the Wesley Room and will be discussing "Believing vs. Following". This is also a mentor night.

May 13th – Newest Edition of Youth News will be shown during both worship services

- No Afternoon classes – Mothers Day

May 20th - Youth night: For our final Youth Night outing before summer, youth have chosen to go to Grand Slam Sports and Entertainment. We will be leaving the church at 2pm (so try to get to Minnehaha a few minutes early) and will be back by 6pm. Cost is \$15 and includes Unlimited Laser tag, Mini golf, and Krazy Karts, as well as a hotdog and soda, and six arcade tokens! What a fantastic deal! We are expecting a large group to attend, so PLEASE be sure to RSVP so that we have enough transportation available. Thank you!

May 26th – MinneHarvest: Youth and families are getting together to volunteer with MinneHarvest. One out of every six Minnesotans are food insecure and our Youth have decided they wanted to help feed those in need. There is two separate times that we could use help, come early and help unload the food truck at 7am, or come later at 9am to help with food distribution and clean up.

June 3rd – Graduation Sunday

June 18th-22nd - Music and Drama Camp & VBS -

Some youth will be participating in Music and Drama camp and other youth will be helping all week as counselors and room leaders with one or both of these two MUMC camps. Have your youth contact Lani Thompson to choose what camp they would like to help with and how they would like to volunteer! It's going to be a great week at Minnehaha!

In case Youth Camps are not on your calendar yet here our the dates, if you want more info talk to Lani Thompson.

- Minnehaha Adventure Camp: July 15-17 (finished grades 5th & 6th this spring) at Koronis Retreat Center

- Minnehaha Wilderness Camp: July 29-Aug 3rd (finished grades 7th-12th this spring) at Star Lake Campgrounds

Leilani Thompson, Director of Youth Ministries

STORIES OF EXTRAORDINARY PEOPLE

MINNEHAHA MUSIC & DRAMA CAMP 2018

**WHEN: MONDAY, JUNE 18-FRIDAY, JUNE 22ND
FROM 8AM – 3PM**

PERFORMANCE: FRIDAY, JUNE 22ND AT 7PM

WHO: KIDS/YOUTH WHO ARE ENTERING 4TH-8TH GRADE

WHERE: MINNEHAHA UNITED METHODIST CHURCH

3701 E. 50TH STREET, MINNEAPOLIS, MN 55417

COST: \$100/PERSON

**JOIN US FOR A WONDERFUL WEEK. TOGETHER, UNDER THE
DIRECTION OF LOCAL ACTOR, DIRECTOR, & TEACHER, MAUREEN
TREPP, WE'LL TAKE ON ALL ASPECTS OF CREATING AN ORIGINAL
MUSICAL PRODUCTION THAT WILL CELEBRATE EXTRAORDINARY
PEOPLE IN THIS WORLD!**

**REGISTER TODAY AT MINNEHAHA UMC
OR BY VISITING WWW.MINNEHAHA.ORG**

Children's Ministries

Ah, it is finally here: spring. And, right around the corner: summer.

We're busy at Minnehaha wrapping up the 2017-2018 Program Year, making plans for summer camps, and getting things for 2018-2019 set in motion. In the midst of this, of course, we do our best to take deep breaths, to savor the wonder of spring, to notice the trees budding and the warmth of the sun. It is a good season. And, we look forward to celebrating a lot throughout this month. We'll celebrate a rite of passage at Minnehaha as we give our second graders Bibles on Sunday, May 6th.

We'll celebrate a year of hard work by amazing volunteers on Children's Sunday.

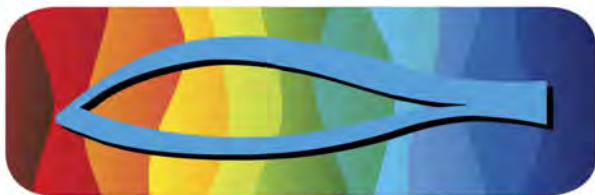
We'll celebrate a year of growing and learning and strengthening community.

We'll celebrate with cake. With time together. With music and prayer and singing.

We'll celebrate the hope of spring, and the joy of summer as we move our seedlings out to the Minnehaha garden.

We'll celebrate the hope we find in our children, and the joy that comes as we watch them grow and become - incredible, passionate, loving individuals.

It is a good season.



OUR DEEPEST THANKS to all of you who have helped in our Minnehaha Faith Formation Programs

Whether you helped with babies or Adult Faith Formation, one Sunday or every week - your gift of time and your talents to this community are invaluable and helped to remind us all how we might be the hands and heart of God in the world. Thank you for making the ministries of Minnehaha possible.

We'll be celebrating the 2017-2018 Program Year on Sunday, May 20th with one worship service at 10am. We hope you'll join us both for worship, and for cake and fellowship afterwards.

*You've served to help others seek,
so now it's time to celebrate!*



When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Childcare Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.

Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop by to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

3701 E. 59th Street, Minneapolis 55417

education@minnehaha.org

612.721.6231

Wednesday night dinner and programming will continue through May 16th, and then go on summer hiatus. Thursday Morning Playgroup continues throughout the summer, but has begun it's exploration of neighborhood parks (weather permitting, Minnehaha is the rain/bad weather site). If you would like to find out where Playgroup is headed each week - join the Facebook group "Minnehaha Playgroup" and/or check on the church website Wednesday each week.

We've got three one service Sundays as we transition from the program year into summer. For each of these Sundays, we have one worship service at 10am, with no Faith Formation hour. We start with Children's Sunday on May 20th, then for Memorial Day on May 27th, and finally for Baccalaureate (Graduation Sunday) on June 3rd. And, on June 10th, our summer schedule - with worship at 9 (indoors, traditional) and 10:30 (outdoors, alternative), and no Faith Formation Hour - begins. We'll kick off the summer worship schedule with a blessing of the bikes & bike helmets, and a potluck picnic. So, mark your calendars now for June 10th!!

And, of course, we've got our summer camps. Vacation Bible School (VBS) runs Wednesday, June 20th-Friday, June 22nd, from 9-11:30am in the morning. This year we're celebrating how God is with us through all kinds of

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Mary Magdalene Study

Jesus challenged many of the norms of his culture in the way he treated women, but 2000 years later we still see the impact of male domination in the institutional church. Have you wondered how this happened? Has Mary Magdalene and her important role in the life of Jesus intrigued you? Join others this summer for a three part discussion session to share our thoughts based on readings of your choice on the subject.

When: Wednesdays, June 27, July 11 and July 25

Time: 3pm to 4:30pm

Where: Kensington Square at Becketwood Cooperative – 4300 West River Parkway

Each participant can choose a book on Mary Magdalene and also can review the Gospels, the material covered last year on The Gospel of Mary Magdalene (or other material in *A New New Testament*.) Some book selections are offered below, including novels. If you are interested and want some ideas about books to read, talk to Jan Hougen, Phyllis Kromer, Todd and Tracy Gulliver or Carol Spearman.

As you read, pay attention to what is said about the following questions: Making notes will be helpful.

Who was Mary Magdalene? (In 591 AD, Pope Gregory connected her to other women in the Gospels and set the stage for her identification as a prostitute. In 2016, the Catholic Church declared that was a mistake and gave her the title – Apostle of the Apostles.)

Why was Mary at the crucifixion and at the gravesite of Jesus and what meaning does it have that was also the first to see Jesus at the tomb?

What was the relationship of Mary to Jesus? What was her relationship to the disciples before and after the death of Jesus?

Where is Mary in the years after the death of Jesus? Who is with her? Why might this be important?

How was the respect for women's leadership roles of the early church lost in the years after the death of Jesus and in the future development of Christianity.

What has been the result of losing the importance of Mary Magdalene and other women leaders in early Christianity?

What can we do today to restore the role of women and feminine energy to the church?

Along the way, you may encounter Black Madonnas, The Holy Grail, Gnostic teachings, Cathars and Templars. Keep reading and exploring and share your findings and thoughts with others.

Book List:

The Woman With the Alabaster Jar and *Mary Magdalene-Bride in Exile* by Margaret Starbird

The Meaning of Mary Magdalene by Cynthia Bourgeault

Mary Called Magdalene by Margaret George (A long novel)

The Book of Love and *The Expected One* by Kathleen McGowan – both novels.

Mary Magdalene The Essential History by Susan Haskins

The Church of Mary Magdalene by Jean Markale

Serve at Simpson

The UMW (and anyone else interested) will be serving at Simpson Shelter on Tuesday, May 29 and welcome any help. We are there from 5:45-8 and can always use help preparing the meal beforehand. Please let Maureen Trepp know if you are interested in helping. We have also added more dates for this fall including one on August 29. Also, we will be assisting Families Moving Forward again at Lake Nokomis Lutheran church during the week of July 29-Aug. 5; you will need to be trained and vetted but you would have fun doing this service.

Have a Blessed Ramadan

Once again this year, the Minnesota Council of Churches is providing signs for Christian and Jewish congregations to put in their lawns wishing our Muslim brothers and sister a blessed Ramadan. Once again this year, we will be putting the sign in our lawn. It's a neighborly thing to do, and given our partnership with the Daud family, we have some extra connections to the practice.

Ramadan is one of the largest Islamic observances. It is a 30-day period which moves around the calendar (this year, it starts at sundown on May 15). It celebrates the first revelation of the Quran to the prophet Mohammad. Ramadan is observed as a time of fasting from all food and drink from sunrise to sunset, and observing Ramadan is one of the five pillars of Islam. Many Muslims time a pilgrimage to Mecca (another of the five pillars) during Ramadan. The observance of Ramadan ends with the celebratory holiday of Eid al-Fitr.

Thanks to all who brought us meals my first week back home from the hospital, also the cards and notes.

Rachel Larson



Join the Minnehaha Men's Softball Team!

Spring is here! Which means the Minnehaha Men's Softball Team is looking for players. Team manager Mike Schow is the guy to contact if you're interested: find him in person at church, or contact the church.

Where we play: Nokomis Ball Fields

When we play: Sunday night double-headers at 5 and 6 pm

Scheduled game nights this year (can be subject to change) are: 5/6, 5/20, 6/10, 6/24, 7/15, and 7/29.

All are invited to come and cheer us on – pack a picnic dinner and spend beautiful summer evenings together.

(Continued from page 5)

adventures to help us find peace and joy. VBS is for children who are 3 as of June 1st (and potty trained) through ten years old. Extended childcare is available if that makes it easier for your child(ren) to participate. Music and Drama Camp is from Monday, June 18th-Friday, June 22nd. Participants work on all aspects of putting on a musical production - this year called "Stories of Extraordinary People." The performance for this will be on Friday, June 22nd at 7pm. Music & Drama Camp is for 3rd-8th graders. If you have a younger child who might be interested, please contact Jenia, and we can see if it will work.

As always, if you have any questions and/or concerns about Children & Family Ministries, please contact Jenia Strom at education@minnehaha.org or 612.721.6231.

Happy Spring,
Jenia Strom
Director of Children & Family Ministries
education@minnehaha.org

All Church Meeting

On Sunday, June 3 at 10:15 the Solar Committee will be requesting a vote on the proposed financing of a 40kW solar system at the church.

The original plan for a 40kW system that was unveiled approximately 2 years ago did not come to fruition. However, the Solar Committee has put together a new plan which requires another form of financing, so we are seeking congregational approval. Please join us on June 3, at 11:15 in church sanctuary. At that time we will be voting on the proposal. We will have two informational meetings prior to the vote, one on May 6th at 10:15 and then the second one at 6:30 on May 16th, both in the Fellowship Hall.

Time for Renewal

It's easy to get caught up in the daily demands of life. In our busyness, we can lose track of ourselves, and of what God is calling us to be and to do. Take an opportunity to slow down, to rest in silence and music, and to feed your soul. On the second Friday of each month at 7:00 p.m. from October through May, we offer a Taizé service, a time of sanctuary, a time for prayer, a time for community, and a time for silence. As we sing and pray, our hearts are opened so that we may hear God speaking to us, and our souls are fed so that we may be about God's work in the world. Please join us this month on May 11 for a time of renewal.

Love Offering Supports

Puerto Rico, Freedom School at Park Avenue UMC and NUMAS Haus

Each year, churches in the Minnesota Annual Conference take a Love Offering for missions. The offering is brought to annual conference session – a gathering of United Methodist clergy and laity from across the state.

This year, the Love Offering will go to three projects:

Puerto Rico Hurricane Recovery Trips – 65%

Hurricanes devastated Puerto Rico last summer and fall. This portion of the love offering will go towards the purchase of construction supplies and relief kits which will be brought to the island by volunteer mission teams. A portion will also go towards scholarships for those wanting to be part of the mission team.

Freedom School at Park Avenue UMC – 20%

The Freedom School program is a six-week summer day camp experience for children in the heart of Minneapolis. It aims to address the “summer slide” and close the achievement gap for 50 students through improved reading skills, art, cooking, music, and physical education. The offering will be used to cover reading curriculum and materials.

NUMAS Haus – 15%

NUMAS Haus provides emergency shelter and support services to homeless single women and their children in New Ulm and surrounding Brown County. Adjacent to First UMC in New Ulm, clients are able to stay there up to 90 days while receiving counseling in a variety of areas and obtaining access to county special services and vocational training. The offering will be used to help families with transitional rent assistance for six to twelve months after completion of the program.

To contribute to the Love Offering, please mark “Love Offering” on your check and either mail it to the church office or put it in the offering plate by May 20.

Food Ministries

MUMC supports **two food ministries**. MinneHarvest is a monthly free food giveaway, and our Food Shelf is a weekly food shelf for residents in our neighborhood, supported by us, Lake Nokomis Lutheran, and St. James Episcopal on the Parkway. Both of these ministries need regular financial support in order for them to continue to provide food to those in need. Please consider making a regular contribution to one or both of these ministries; you can use the handy envelopes provided in the pews, or you can write a check and indicate either MinneHarvest or Food Shelf on the memo line.

Composting at Church

Folks who attended Hope Hutchison's recent class on God's Renewed Creation came up with ideas about how to expand composting here at the MUMC building, as a way to extend and deepen our care of the environment.

As a first step, we are recruiting a team of people to pick up compost each week already being collected at the church, and take it home to dispose of in their organics bins (furnished by the city) for pick-up. Right now Pastor Becky is doing this, but we would like a composting team could take over this task. If you already have organics pick up through the city at home and would like to be a member of this team, or have questions, please contact Susan Delattre, at sbdelattre@yahoo.com or catch her at church between services.

Potluck Garden Party

Our first outdoor potluck of the summer season will be on Sunday, June 10, following the second service. Bring a dish to share and something to put on the grill, take a stroll around the garden to see what's growing (pull a couple weeds . . .), play on the playground, and mingle with other Minnehaha folk.

**the children of Minnehaha United Methodist Church
proudly present...**



**Somali Museum Tour
Rescheduled (thanks to our April blizzard)
for Sunday, June 3rd at 1pm**

Join with other members of the Minnehaha community to learn more about Somali culture by visiting The Somali Museum of Minnesota.

To learn more about the museum, you can go to somalimuseum.org.

Cost is \$9 per adult and \$7 per child/senior

If you are interested in joining our group, please RSVP with Mary Vrabel vrabelmiles@gmail.com or Jenia Strom at education@minnehaha.org by Friday, June 1st

We will meet at the Museum at 1:00, 1516 E Lake St #011
(in the basement of the Plaza Verde building).

First Friday Films

Do you find yourself shouting advice to characters during a movie? Nudging your neighbor with an elbow during critical scenes? Wishing you had someone to talk to about the movie you just watched? Then you are in luck! Come to the church on the first Friday of the month at 7:00 and settle in to watch a movie with fellow Minnehaha-ians. Bring your own beverage and snacks, and feel free to bring a friend as well. After the credits roll, you'll have an opportunity to share your "aha" moments, the things you liked or disliked, or anything else the movie prompted in you.

This month, we'll watch the comedy/drama ***A Man Called Ove***. Stepping from the pages of Fredrik Backman's international best-selling novel, Ove is the quintessential angry old man next door. An isolated retiree with strict principles and a short fuse, who spends his days enforcing block association rules that only he cares about, and visiting his wife's grave, Ove has given up on life. Enter a boisterous young family next door who accidentally flattens Ove's mailbox while moving in and earning his special brand of ire. Yet from this inauspicious beginning an unlikely friendship forms and we come to understand Ove's past happiness and heartbreaks. What emerges is a heartwarming tale of unreliable first impressions and the gentle reminder that life is sweeter when it's shared. We look forward to seeing you on Friday, May 4 at 7:00 in Room 310.

United Methodist Women

UMW news: Big events in May! We will be attending the Emma Norton Services Dinner and Silent Auction on May 7, beginning at 4:30 with dinner at 6:15. We have reserved a table for our UMW and there's room for you! Please let Maureen Trepp know you are interested in going to this interesting event. We will car pool from church at 4:00. Eight women are attending the National Assembly in Columbus, OH from May 17-21, riding together on the UMW district chartered bus. We will be joining women from around the country and world for this event and are sponsored with funds raised by your UMW. Please keep us in your prayers.

Communion at Nokomis Square

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., there is a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a discussion of United Methodist beliefs. In May we will be gathering on May 10.

ROLLING RIVER RAMPAGE

Minnehaha UMC's Vacation Bible School 2018

When: Wednesday, June 20th - Friday, June 22nd
from 9-11:30am *Extended Childcare Available*
Who: Children who are 3 (and potty-trained) - 10 years old
Where: Minnehaha United Methodist Church
Cost: \$25/child or \$40/family
Register today at Minnehaha UMC or online at www.minnehaha.org.

Experience the ride of a lifetime! At Minnehaha, we'll spend these three mornings connecting with old friends and new. We'll learn all about how God is present in our lives. We'll do crafts, play games, conduct science experiments, create snacks, hear stories, sing songs, and more. Invite your friends and join us for **Rolling River Rampage!**

*When you pass through the waters,
I will be with you.*

-Isaiah 43:2





Renewal



When I first started ministry, I was in a study group with the other United Methodist clergy in my county. It had men and women, those just starting in ministry and those who'd been around awhile, churches that were small and churches that were large. It was a fine group of people, and I appreciate the many ways in which they mentored me. I learned some important life and work lessons from them.

One of those lessons was about work/life balance. A short while after I joined the group, a couple of the more experienced clergy announced that they were taking partial sabbaticals. They were feeling burned out, some were beginning to suspect they were battling depression, and so they were taking some time off. The denomination recommends that clergy take time for continuing education and renewal – a day a month, a week a year, and a month a quadrennium (every 4 years). Since they had not taken any of that time earlier, they were now taking partial sabbaticals – one for four months and another for 6 months. During my training in seminary, I had been encouraged to take seriously time for renewal. This is a marathon, not a sprint, we were told. Watching my more experienced colleagues, I decided that rather than waiting 20 years, I would take that renewal month every 4 years. It is, of course, harder than it sounds. The timing of appointment changes, the needs of the congregation and other staff all come in to play, but over my 26 years of ministry, I have taken 3 renewal leaves. Each one of them has been a much-needed respite, and at each one I have returned to ministry feeling refreshed and more able to tackle what lies in front of us.

This summer will be my 4th renewal leave. The Staff Parish Relations Committee has graciously allowed me to take a month (plus a week of my vacation) from June 4-July 8 to disconnect from Minnehaha. During that time, I won't be checking emails or returning for important events, but the church will be in good hands. The rest of the staff will continue to do the things they do so well, a group of people from the congregation have agreed to tell their faith stories as a sermon series, and there will be wonderful and compassionate people on call in case of hospitalizations, emergencies, and deaths. I fully anticipate that I will come back feeling renewed, and I also fully anticipate that you will enjoy hearing about faith life from the perspective of others. My guess is that you will hardly even notice that I am gone. I want to extend my thanks to SPR and to all of you for being gracious to me and letting me run this this marathon of ministry.

In joy,
Becky





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5/18



One Service Sundays

We will be having one service at 10:00 for these four weeks:

- May 20 – one service inside at 10:00 for the Children's Musical
- May 27 – one service inside at 10:00. Memorial Day weekend. We'll also try to have our annual practice fire drill following the service
- June 3 – one service inside at 10:00 to celebrate our graduating seniors with a special coffee hour in their honor following the service

Our summer schedule of 9:00 indoors and 10:30 outdoors will begin on Sunday, June 10 with a blessing of bikes and bike helmets and a potluck picnic outside following worship.



We celebrated Earth Day with planting seeds! We'll nurture them along and then move them out to the Minnehaha Garden on May 20th